Teacher: Then why do we use kilogram, metre, litre instead of those units?

Student: I don't know teacher, please tell us why?.

Teacher: As we started trading world wide ,we found people in various places using different measures. The 'kings foot', the 'kings arm' and the 'yard' (the distance between the tip of his nose to the tip of the thumb) were used as units to measure small length in various places. As these lengths differed from person to person and place to place, it was necessary to standardize measurements throughout the world. The metric measures were defined in 1971 by the General Conference of Weights and Measures.



The basic metric units are Metre, Litre, Gram, Seconds and so on. It is based on the decimal system (10), which is easier to convert from one unit to another. We use kilometre, metre, centimetre, millimetre to measure length; kilogram, gram, milligram for weight and kilolitre, litre, millilitre for volume in shops, schools ,office, railways and many other places.

An eye blink represents a second; heart beats are counted per minute; working time of an employee is calculated in hours.

MATHEMATICS ALIVE – MEASUREMENTS IN REAL LIFE



Cloth measure in a textile shop



Weighing Vegetables in a market



Measuring the volume of milk by the seller

2.2 Recap

Universally accepted basic metric units are

- Length in metre.
- Weight in gram.
- Capacity (volume) in litre.

We use different metric units for different sizes in various situations

Size	Metric units
Large ones	Kilometre / Kilolitre / Kilogram
Medium ones	Metre / Litre /Gram
Small ones	Centimetre / Centilitre /Centigram
Very small ones	Millimetre/Millilitre / Milligram

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